

Overcalls

Because of the Defensive element, the most important requirement for an Overcall is that you have a good suit, one that you'd like partner to lead. Keep in mind:

- a 5-card or longer suit with honor strength

- 9-16 points to overcall at the 1-level

- 11-16 points to overcall at the 2-level

Takeout Doubles

There are three kinds of Takeout Double:

- opening hand strength, no more than 2 of opponent's suit, at least 3 in all other suits
- strong Overcall type, at least 17 points and a good suit. Double, then bid the suit.
- strong Notrump type, 19+ points, stopper in their suit. Double, then bid notrump.

Responding to a Takeout Double

- 0-8 points, bid your best suit as cheaply as possible

- 9-11 points, jump in your best suit

- 12 or more points, cue-bid the opponent's suit

Board: 1

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 1NT

Declarer: North

Lead:  4

Board: 2

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Lead:  2

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4 

Declarer: South

Lead:  3

Board: 4

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4 

Declarer: West

Lead:  10

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 9
 ♥ 10 9 5
 ♦ K Q 10
 ♣ A 9 3 2

♠ A 8 6
 ♥ K Q J
 ♦ A J 9 7
 ♣ K Q 4



♠ 7 4 3
 ♥ A 8 3
 ♦ 5 4 3 2
 ♣ 10 7 5

♠ J 10 5 2
 ♥ 7 6 4 2
 ♦ 8 6
 ♣ J 8 6

NORTH has 20 points, excellent ♦ stoppers and a balanced hand. She is two points too strong to overcall 1NT. Instead, she doubles.

SOUTH has an awful hand - but since he is forced to bid he says 1♠, assuming NORTH wants to hear his best suit.

NORTH now bids 1NT, showing the balanced 19-21 point hand. SOUTH passes, of course.

West	North	East	South
1♦	Dbl	Pass	1♠
Pass	1NT		
All Pass			
1NT by North			
Lead: ♦4			

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K J 6 2

♥ 6 5

♦ A Q 3

♣ 9 8 7 4

♠ A 10 3

♥ 9 7 4 3

♦ 10 9 2

♣ Q 5 2



♠ Q 7 4

♥ A Q 10

♦ K J 7 5

♣ A K 6

♠ 9 8 5

♥ K J 8 2

♦ 8 6 4

♣ J 10 3

EAST has a 19 point balanced hand, including a stop in ♥s. He plans to double, then bid NT. (see Deal 9)

WEST has 10 points though, so he jumps to 2♠.

In theory EAST could now bid 2NT to continue the description of his hand, but he might as well go ahead and bid 3NT instead.

*West**North**East**South*

2♠

1♥

Dbl

Pass

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♥2

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8 6
 ♥ K 7 3 2
 ♦ A 8 7 6
 ♣ 10 8 3

♠ K J 4 2

♥ A 8 5

♦ K J 3 2

♣ J 2



♠ 9 7

♥ Q J 10 9

♦ 9 5 4

♣ K Q 6 5

♠ A Q 10 5 3

♥ 6 4

♦ Q 10

♣ A 9 7 4

With a 5-card ♠ suit and 13 points SOUTH should overcall 1 ♠.

NORTH has 13 points and four ♠s. If SOUTH had opened, NORTH's hand would be good enough to insist on game. But since SOUTH overcalled, NORTH merely invites with a jump to 3 ♠.

SOUTH has better than a minimum overcall so she accepts the invitation and bids 4 ♠.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1 ♥	1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♥ 3			

Board 4

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 3
♥ K Q 9 8 6 4
♦ A 5 2
♣ 9 5

♠ 10 9 8 2
♥ A
♦ K 10 8 4 3
♣ 8 4 2



♠ K J 6 4
♥ J 10 7 5
♦ 6
♣ A K J 3

♠ A 7 5
♥ 3 2
♦ Q J 9 7
♣ Q 10 7 6

EAST has a very minimum Takeout Double of 1♦. But what it lacks in strength, it makes up for with perfect distribution.

WEST has 13 points and only wants to play in one contract, 4♥.

EAST passes happily.

West	North	East	South
	1♦	Dbl	Pass
4♥			
All Pass			
4♥ by West			
Lead: ♠10			